Data Classification
WyIT.2001

Policy Owner	Drew Dilly, Chief Data Officer
Policy Contact	Pat Potter, Deputy Chief Data Officer
Policy Approver	Jeff Clines, Chief Information Officer
Effective Date	
Next Review Date	October 01, 2027
Policy Version	

Scope:

This policy governs proper information classification, protection, and handling of State of Wyoming information, regardless of format (e.g., written and/or electronic), using a domain-based approach. It establishes the foundation for protecting information based on sensitivity, ensuring regulatory compliance, and implementing appropriate controls throughout the information lifecycle.

This policy serves as the state baseline. Agencies may implement more restrictive policies to meet applicable state and federal regulations or agency-specific requirements, provided they do not deviate substantially from this policy. In lieu of agency-specific policies, this policy shall serve as the governing standard.

Authority

This policy is promulgated under the authority of Wyoming State Statute 9-2-2906 and its subsections, the Department of Enterprise Technology Services is required to adopt and enforce information technology standards, and promote efficient use of information technology throughout state government.

Specifically, this policy is further promulgated under the authority of the below listed Wyoming State Statute subsections.

- Implements and maintains an information technology governance program for state agencies (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (ii));
- Establishes and enforces data security and privacy policies and standards for the state data infrastructure Establishes review criteria for the agencies information technology projects, procurements and purchases. (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (iii)); and

Adopts information technology policies and standards and ensures agency compliance with those policies and standards (W.S. 9-2-2906,(b), (vi)).

Audience

This policy applies to all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions staff (collectively referred to as "agencies"). This policy is also applicable to consultants, affiliates, third party vendors and temporary employees that use or store state data.

Definitions

Key Definitions, Acronyms, and Terms

Data Classification Levels:

- **Public (Low Sensitivity)**
  - Information that poses no risk to the State if made generally available.
  - This includes information intended for public release or already publicly available.
  - Example data types: press releases, public meeting minutes, published reports, agency contact information, public-facing website content.
- **Internal (Moderate Sensitivity)**:
  - Information whose loss, corruption, or unauthorized disclosure is of importance only inside the State and, therefore, would not result in a tangible business, financial, or legal loss.
  - This information is not routinely shared outside the State government but is generally accessible to State employees.
- **Confidential (High Sensitivity)**:
  - Information whose loss, corruption, or unauthorized disclosure would seriously harm an individual's, business's, or the State's reputation or business position, resulting in severe financial and legal loss.
  - Confidential information is subject to controlled access and special handling requirements.
    - **Confidential-Standard**: Sensitive business or operational information
    - **Confidential-Regulated**: Information subject to specific regulatory requirements

Policy Statements:

1. Agencies must classify all State of Wyoming data and information, regardless of format, structure, or formal asset designation, according to one of the three classification levels defined in this policy:

   1.1. Public (Low Sensitivity);

   1.2. Internal (Moderate Sensitivity);

   1.3. Confidential (High Sensitivity);

   1.4. Classification must occur upon data creation, acquisition, or when existing data undergoes significant modification.

   [1], [2], [3], [4], [5]

2. Any agency that collects, uses, or stores information must identify and train a data owner with responsibility over that data and the related controls.
   [1], [2], [3], [4], [6], [7], [6], [8]

   2.1. Data Owners are responsible for classifying information assets according to their sensitivity and applicable regulatory requirements.
   [1], [3], [4], [5], [8]

3. All data and information classified as Confidential-Regulated must be protected in accordance with applicable federal and state regulations. Data owners are responsible for understanding applicable regulations, applying and auditing controls, and partnering with Enterprise Technology Services (ETS) on technical control implementation.
   [9], [1], [10], [8], [3], [4], [12], [13]

   3.1. Confidential-Regulated information must not be stored on portable or removable storage media, except when specifically authorized in writing by the relevant Agency Head or Program Manager. When such storage is approved:

      3.1.1 Each storage device must have a designated and identifiable owner;

      3.1.2. The media must be encrypted using FIPS 140-2 validated encryption;

      3.1.3. The media must be physically secured at all times; and

      3.1.4. A documented inventory of all such media must be maintained.

   [9], [10], [14], [21], [13], [11]

4. Information handling procedures established in related Wyoming policies must be applied according to the classification level assigned under this policy, with higher classification levels requiring more stringent controls.
   [1], [22], [23], [24], [25], [21], [26], [3], [4], [5]

5. All employees and affiliates must be trained on their agency's information classification procedures and responsibilities for protecting agency information. Data owners must ensure that all employees and affiliates with access to data and systems under their authority receive training on proper data handling responsibilities.
[1], [3], [11], [5]

6. Agencies shall maintain comprehensive data inventories as required by W.S. 9-21-101(a)(i) and organize their data and information into logical data domains that group related data types to ensure consistent classification decisions and effective governance.
[1], [3], [5]

7. When information consists of elements with different classification levels, the entire information asset shall be classified at the highest level of any component element (classification inheritance).
[1], [5]

Applicable State Policies, Federal, State or Industry Rules, Laws, and/or Regulations

1. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-53, Rev 5
2. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework v2.0
3. Center for Internet Security (CIS) Critical Security Controls Ver 8
4. Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Ver 2.0
5. ISO/IEC 27001
6. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Privacy Framework
7. Wyoming Statute .S. 9-21-101(a)(i)
8. WyIT.2001-S1, Data Owner Standard
9. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-171, Rev 2
10. FBI Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) Security Policy
11. Health Insurance Privacy and Accountability Act (HIPAA), Security Rule
12. Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), 34 CFR Part 99
13. IRS Publication 1075
14. WyIT.2005, Information Residency and Transportation
15. WyIT.2001-S2, Data Steward Standard
16. WyIT.2001-S3, Data Custodian Standard
17. WyIT.2001-S4, Data Domain Standard
18. WyIT.2001-G1, Information Classification Guide
19. WyIT.2001-G2, Information Classification Procedures Guide
20. Wyoming Public Records Act (W.S.§ 16-4-201 through 16-4-205)
21. WyIT.2013, Electronic Data Destruction and Sanitization
22. WyIT.2003, Data Backup, Storage and Restoration
23. WyIT. 2005, Information Residency and Transportation
24. WyIT.2009, “Clean Desk” Confidential Information and Sensitive Materials Policy
25. WyIT 2014, Data Sharing Agreement Documentation Governance
26. WyIT.3015, Physical Media

Compliance & Exceptions:

Compliance

Employees who violate this policy may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action up to and including discharge as well as both civil and criminal penalties. Non-employees, including, without limitation, contractors, may be subject to termination of contractual agreements, denial of access to IT resources, and other actions as well as both civil and criminal penalties.

Exceptions

Requests for exceptions to this policy shall be reviewed by the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and the Chief Information Officer (CIO). Departments requesting exceptions shall provide such requests to the CIO in accordance with WyIT.3002 Policy Exception Request.

The request should specifically state the scope of the exception along with justification for granting the exception, the potential impact or risk attendant upon granting the exception, risk mitigation measures to be undertaken by the IT Department, initiatives, actions and a time-frame for achieving the minimum compliance level with the policies set forth herein. The CIO shall review such requests; confer with the requesting department.

Any exception to established policy shall be defined and tracked as a risk to the state and established mitigating controls monitored by the agency.

Review/Approval:

Date Issued/Review Date

This policy shall be reviewed at least annually and updated / reviewed / approved as defined in the Office of Chief Information Officer (OCIO) Policy lifecycle.

The review and update process shall be coordinated by Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC), completed by the policy owner and approved through the OCIO policy review workflow.

Approval

This policy as signed by the appropriate officer (listed below) is considered approved and enforced, per Wyoming State Statutes (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (iii)) and (W.S. 9-2-2906,(b), (vi)).

To obtain a signed copy of this document, contact Enterprise Technology Services Governance, Risk and Compliance (ets-ocio-grc@wyo.gov).

Jeffrey Clines Officer Name	Chief Information Officer Officer Title
_____ Officer's Signature	_____ Date

Revision History

The current version of this policy, as identified in the Revision History below, supersedes all previous documents listed below.

Version	Change	Author(s)	Date of Change
2026-09.1	ETS Director signature	GRC	September 2026
2025-09.3	WyIT 2001, Information Classification, Updated Document Template	Pat Potter	September 2025
2025-01.2	Updated Document Classification Levels	Drew Dilly, CDO	January 2025
2024-06.1	WyIT 2001, Information Classification, Originally Published	Pat Potter, Deputy CDO	June 2024
UKN	08100-P131, Policy Information Classification	UKN	November 2018